

Noah Franco, LHP, TCU

2026 Stats: 7.20 ERA/15 IP/1.867 WHIP/19 K/11 BB/1.73 K:BB

6-3, 225

Metrics

SI: 94.6/9.5 IVB/-16.3 HB/-6.21 VAA/6.3 ext/5.8 relH/34.7% zone/28.2 AA/60.1% usage/2310 rpm

SL: 84.6/-0.8 IVB/9.8 HB/-8.09 VAA/31.7% zone/27 AA/37.4% usage/2650 rpm

CH: 85.5/2.6 IVB/-9.3 HB/-7.84 VAA/14.3% zone/29.7 AA/2.5% usage/1020 rpm

Write-up

Franco is a physical left-hander with a sinker-heavy arsenal built around power velocity and arm-side run. The profile is designed to induce ground balls and weak contact rather than miss bats in volume, but inconsistent strike-throwing and limited pitch repertoire led to difficulty sustaining at-bats in 2026. The delivery and physicality point to a bullpen role at the next level. He is a plus athlete, playing OF and 1B for the Horned Frogs this year. He also missed a month with an oblique injury sustained against UCLA in late February. While the stuff is playable, the lack of a consistent putaway pitch and zone-location issues against both righties and lefties limited his ability to navigate lineups efficiently. The profile remains interesting as a ground-ball leverage reliever if command stabilizes, but the starter path is largely closed.

The SI profiles with heavy ASR and average sink. He showed the ability to throw down in the zone to LHH but to RHH he threw too many elevated sinkers which came through the zone flat and failed to get enough ground balls to get outs. Being able to locate better D/A to RHH will be the next step in his development as a high leverage reliever. 40/45 pitch

The SL was inconsistent, getting both big sweep and tight gyro at times. The command was also inconsistent, not showing promise at keeping the slider down. It was able to get whiffs when located beneath the belt and there was CS elevated, but with the pure lateral shape, it won't work long term as a CS pitch to RHH at the top of the zone. Being able to bury backfoot to left and low backdoor will

help the pitch in the future. It has good traits at its best being firm with above average gloveside, but the present feel and consistency for the slider is not quite there yet. 40/45+ pitch

The CH is a non factor in its current form, getting below average depth and run, often cutting at times. He was 1/7 at locating in the zone. Developing a usable SPL/CH will be imperative for evolving into a HLRP. 30/30 pitch